The Lantern in the Rain

The rain had been falling since morning, turning the narrow village paths into streams of mud. Aarav pulled his jacket tighter as he walked, holding a small lantern to guide his way.

“Wait for me!” a cheerful voice called behind him.

It was Meera, a lively little girl with bright eyes, hopping over puddles as if they were part of a game. She finally caught up, slightly out of breath but smiling.

“You walk too fast,” she said.

Aarav smirked. “Or maybe you stop to play too much.”

They were heading to the edge of the village, where an old house stood beneath a giant banyan tree. Inside lived Devyani, a calm and thoughtful woman known for helping everyone in the village. She had asked Aarav to bring some supplies.

As they reached the house, the door creaked open before they could knock.

“I was expecting you,” Devyani said gently, her voice warm despite the storm. “Come in, both of you.”

Inside, the air was filled with the scent of herbs and tea. Sitting by the window was an old man named Bhaskar, wrapped in a shawl, watching the rain as if it held secrets.

“You’re late,” Bhaskar said, not unkindly.

“The rain slowed us down,” Aarav replied, placing the supplies on the table.

Meera wandered closer to Bhaskar. “Why do you keep staring outside?”

The old man smiled faintly. “Because every storm tells a story. You just have to listen.”

“Does this one have a story?” she asked.

Devyani handed them all warm cups of tea. “It does,” she said. “It’s about patience… and finding light even in the darkest weather.”

A sudden flicker shook the room—the lantern Aarav carried dimmed for a moment.

Bhaskar leaned forward. “That lantern… it’s old, isn’t it?”

“It belonged to my father,” Aarav said. “Why?”

The old man’s eyes softened. “Because it’s not just a lantern. It reminds you that even a small light can guide many people.”

Meera looked at the glowing flame, fascinated. “So it’s like… hope?”

Devyani smiled. “Exactly.”

Outside, the rain began to slow. The storm that once felt endless was fading, just like Bhaskar had said it would.

Aarav picked up the lantern again, its light steady now.

“Looks like the story’s ending,” he said.

Bhaskar shook his head. “No… it’s just beginning. Every storm leaves something behind.”

Meera grinned. “Then let’s go find it!”

And together—the man, the woman, the child, and the old storyteller—they stepped out into the quiet, glowing evening, where the world felt new again.